

Energy sector's transformation: 64% embrace open source for innovation



According to the recently released '2023 Energy Transformation Readiness Study' by Linux Foundation Energy, G-PST, RWTH Aachen, and Zpryme, more than 75% of utilities have digitalisation plans and over half are turning to open source to power their innovation. The report offers survey-based insights that clearly show that the industry is poised for tremendous change in the coming years, and the use of open source is playing a pivotal role in driving growth.

The Asia Pacific region is leading the way in implementing digitalisation plans with an impressive 84%! North America is close behind at 78%, with Europe at 62%.

The report's key findings include:

- Of the energy stakeholders surveyed, 76% have a clear strategic plan for digitalisation.
- Additionally, 64% of those surveyed are using open source technology to accelerate that innovation.
- Over half of utilities are merging IT with OT (operational technology) to optimise operational efficiency.

The study reveals that 80% of utilities are investing in digital technologies to improve customer experience. On the other hand, 74% are focusing on improving operational efficiency. These two factors seem to be the top priorities for the industry, as utility companies look for innovative ways to adapt to the digital age. This report is based on a survey of 441 energy stakeholders, vendors, utilities, and other key industry players.

Dr Fatih Birol, executive director of the International Energy Agency (IEA), said, "Digitalisation is blurring the lines between supply and demand. The electricity sector and smart grids are at the centre of this transformation, but ultimately all sectors across both energy supply and demand – households, transport, and industry – will be affected."

The LF Energy report findings make it crystal clear that for utilities to stay competitive and provide better service to customers, digitalisation and open source must be embraced with both hands.

Guanaco, a potential open source project rival to ChatGPT

Guanaco, an open source initiative from researchers at the University of Chile and the University of Talca, is challenging the current industry leader, ChatGPT, in the AI language model space. Astonishingly, Guanaco is able to perform at the same level as ChatGPT while only needing to be trained for a single day, thanks to the use of QLoRA -- a technology that significantly reduces the amount of GPU RAM required. While the 65-billion parameter version of ChatGPT requires 780GB of GPU RAM, Guanaco requires only 5GB for its basic version.

The potential for customisation and flexibility in Guanaco's design is what really sets it apart from ChatGPT. Sam Charrington, the founder of the AI education platform, TWIML, however, isn't entirely convinced of the model's ability to outperform its predecessor: "Guanaco's capability to match ChatGPT while consuming less GPU RAM is undoubtedly a tremendous feat. Nevertheless, its performance on more intricate tasks has yet to be seen."

Regardless of these lingering questions, Guanaco's development has undoubtedly moved us closer towards the dream of accessible, customisable AI language models.

